



English — Cbse English Language & Literature — 80 Marks

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The question paper has five sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D & E (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Sections D-E assess the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.
4. Marks for each question are indicated against it.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 2 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Plastic We Cannot See Plastic pollution is often imagined as bottles floating on rivers or bags tangled in branches, but the most pervasive form of plastic waste is one we rarely notice. Microplastics — fragments smaller than five millimetres — have quietly spread through nearly every corner of the natural world. They originate from the breakdown of larger plastic items, synthetic textile fibres shed during washing, and microbeads once common in cosmetics. Because they are too small to be filtered out by most wastewater systems, they slip into rivers, oceans, and farmland almost unnoticed. Once microplastics enter water bodies, they are ingested by fish, plankton, and other aquatic organisms. From there, they travel up the food chain, eventually reaching the seafood on our plates. Agricultural soil is another major sink. When sewage sludge is used as fertiliser, the plastic particles it carries settle into the ground, where they can be absorbed by crops. Scientists have even detected microplastics in table salt, honey, and drinking water. The human health effects are still being studied, but early research suggests that these particles can accumulate in organs and may cause inflammation. What makes microplastics particularly troubling is their persistence. Unlike organic matter, they do not biodegrade; they simply fragment into ever smaller pieces. A single synthetic garment can release thousands of fibres in one wash cycle. These fibres are so fine that standard washing-machine filters cannot trap them. The result is a slow, invisible accumulation in the environment that no single cleanup effort can reverse. Despite the scale of the problem, individual choices do matter. Choosing clothing made from natural fibres like cotton or wool reduces fibre shedding. Refusing single-use plastics, carrying reusable bags, and buying unpackaged produce cut down the volume of plastic that eventually fragments. Installing a microfiber filter on washing machines, though not yet mandatory, can capture a significant share of fibres before they reach drains. Supporting policies that ban unnecessary microbeads and push for better waste-water treatment is equally important. Microplastics may be invisible to the naked eye, but their presence is a visible reminder of how deeply consumer habits shape the planet. The solution is not a single dramatic gesture but a sustained shift in everyday behaviour — one wash, one purchase, one refusal at a time. (i) Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as a source of microplastics? [1 mark(s)] (A) Breakdown of larger plastic items (B) Synthetic textile fibres shed during washing (C) Natural fibres like cotton and wool (D) Microbeads once common in cosmetics	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(ii) What can be inferred about most wastewater systems from the passage? [1 mark(s)] (A) They convert microplastics into harmless organic matter. (B) They are designed to filter out microplastics efficiently. (C) They are the sole cause of microplastic pollution in oceans. (D) They are unable to remove microplastic particles before they reach natural water bodies. (iii) The word 'pervasive' in paragraph 1 most nearly means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Harmless to humans (B) Widespread and difficult to avoid (C) Recently discovered (D) Visible and large in size (iv) The passage suggests that microplastics are particularly difficult to manage because: [1 mark(s)] (A) They do not biodegrade and simply fragment into smaller pieces. (B) They dissolve completely in seawater. (C) They can be easily filtered by standard washing machines. (D) They are produced only in laboratories. (v) The author's overall stance in the passage is best described as: [1 mark(s)] (A) Cautiously optimistic that individual and policy-level actions can reduce the problem. (B) Completely hopeless about the microplastic crisis. (C) Critical of agricultural practices alone. (D) Indifferent to the environmental impact of consumer habits. (vi) How do microplastics enter agricultural soil, according to the passage? [1 mark(s)] (vii) Why does the author describe microplastics as 'invisible to the naked eye' yet still a 'visible reminder'? [1 mark(s)] (viii) Which word used in the passage means 'to gradually gather or build up over time'? [1 mark(s)] (ix) Explain how the passage links everyday consumer choices to the microplastic problem and suggests solutions at both individual and policy levels. [2 mark(s)]	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
2	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Empty Nest The house had always been a restless thing, alive with the clatter of sneakers on the staircase and the steady hum of the television drifting up from the living room. Now, as Mira stood in the doorway of her daughter's room, the silence felt almost solid, like a held breath waiting to be released. The posters had been taken down carefully, leaving faint rectangles of brighter paint on the walls — ghostly frames of a childhood that had quietly slipped away. On the desk sat a single hairpin, overlooked in the careful packing. Mira picked it up and turned it between her fingers, feeling its familiar weight. It was a small thing, yet it held the warmth of hurried mornings and the scent of jasmine shampoo. She wondered how so many years had folded into a single afternoon of suitcases and last instructions. She remembered the first day of school, a tiny hand gripping hers, then slowly letting go. She remembered the scraped knees, the whispered secrets, the slammed doors of adolescence. Every stage had been a rehearsal for this final departure, though she had never quite believed it would arrive. Downstairs, a horn honked twice. Her daughter called out, "Maa, I'll be fine!" The words were light, almost breezy, but they carried the weight of a promise. Mira smiled, though her eyes glistened. She placed the hairpin on the windowsill and walked down to the gate. The empty nest was not an ending; it was simply the space where love learned to fly without a net. (i) What does the silence in Mira's daughter's room feel like to her? [1 mark(s)] (A) Almost solid, like a held breath waiting to be released (B) A peaceful calm after years of noise (C) A welcome relief from constant chaos (D) An unfamiliar and frightening presence (ii) What does Mira's act of placing the hairpin on the windowsill instead of keeping it most likely signify? [1 mark(s)] (A) She no longer cares about small mementos of her daughter (B) She is accepting the departure rather than clinging to the past (C) She plans to pack it carefully for the next trip (D) She is angry at being left behind in the house (iii) The word 'glistened' as used in the passage most nearly means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Dried up and became rough (B) Closed tightly and firmly (C) Shone with a sparkling, wet light (D) Turned red with sudden anger (iv) What does the forgotten hairpin symbolise for Mira? [1 mark(s)]	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(v) Why does the author describe every stage of growing up as a 'rehearsal for this final departure'? [1 mark(s)] (vi) How does the final sentence redefine the idea of the 'empty nest'? What does it suggest about parental love? [2 mark(s)]	
Section B – Writing Attempt 2 out of 2.		
3	Informal Letter You are Aarav/Ananya, a Class 9 student living at 45, Rose Garden Road, Chandigarh. Your cousin Siddharth/Sneha, who lives in Delhi, has not visited your family for over a year. Write a letter to him/her inviting him/her to spend the summer holidays with your family. In your letter you may touch upon the following cues: • A family trip to Shimla planned for the first week of June • Your grandmother's 75th birthday celebration in mid-June • How long it has been since you last met and how much everyone misses him/her Word limit: 100-150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100-150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Paragraph Write a paragraph in 90-130 words on My Best Friend. You may use the following cues: • Introduce your best friend (name, how you met) and describe their appearance and personality. • Mention shared interests and one occasion when your friend supported you. • Explain why this friendship matters to you. <i>(Word limit: 90-130 words; Suggested time: 15 min)</i>	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	Formal Letter You are Vihaan/Mehul Kapoor, a resident of 27, Green Park Avenue, Indore. On 5 May 2025 you purchased a TurboChef 28L Microwave Oven (Model TC-28L, Serial No. 88412, Lot No. TC-28L-0425) from Sunrise Electronics, an authorised dealer of TurboChef Appliances India Pvt. Ltd. After just ten days of normal use the oven stopped heating, though the turntable and display still work. The product carries a one-year warranty. Write a formal letter to the Customer Service Manager, TurboChef Appliances India Pvt. Ltd., 4th Floor, Tower B, Mumbai requesting a free replacement. Your letter must cover the following points: • Full product details: model, serial number, lot number, date and place of purchase. • Nature of the defect and when it appeared. • Mention of attached invoice and warranty card. • A constructive suggestion: request the company to conduct a quality check on the entire batch (Lot No. TC-28L-0425) to prevent similar failures for other customers. Word limit: 100–150 words (body only). <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Informal Letter You are Aarav/Ananya, a Class 9 student living at 27, Lotus Colony, Jaipur. Your younger brother Vihaan, who studies in Class 7 at a boarding school in Ajmer, has been spending too much time on his phone playing games and watching videos. His recent test scores have dropped, and your parents are worried. Write a letter to Vihaan advising him on how to balance his studies and screen time. In your letter you may include: • your concern about his excessive phone use and falling grades • practical tips to limit screen time and improve study habits • an encouraging note or incentive to motivate him <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i>	5
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
5	Do not touch the exhibits in the museum. [Active & Passive Voice] (A) Let not the exhibits in the museum be touched. (B) The exhibits in the museum not be touched. (C) Let the exhibits in the museum being not touched. (D) Let the exhibits in the museum not be touched.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
6	One of the scientists who ___ the vaccine was honoured with a prestigious award. [Subject-Verb Concord] (A) has discovered (B) discovered (C) discovers (D) was discovered	1
7	She spoke as if she ___ an expert on the subject. [Clauses] (A) was (B) is (C) were (D) has been	1
8	Iron is more useful than any other metal. [Sentence Transformation] (A) No other metal is as useful as iron. (B) No other metal is more useful than iron. (C) Iron is as useful as any other metal. (D) Very few metals are as useful as iron.	1
9	Each of the participants who completed the marathon ___ a certificate of achievement. [Gap Filling] (A) receives (B) receive (C) were given (D) is receiving	1
10	They postponed ___ the annual function due to unforeseen circumstances that arose at the last moment. [Participles & Gerunds] (A) to hold (B) holding (C) hold (D) to holding	1
11	The strict librarian did not let the students ___ more than three reference books at a time during the examination period. [Non-Finite Verbs] (A) to borrow (B) borrowing (C) borrow (D) borrowed	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
12	Extreme weather conditions ___ disrupt flight schedules, causing inconvenience to hundreds of passengers. [Modals] (A) might (B) ought (C) would (D) can	1
13	In the sentence "The scientist explained how [Direct & Indirect Objects] (A) the vaccine (B) the immune system (C) how the vaccine stimulates the immune system to produce antibodies (D) antibodies	1
14	The exhibition is being inaugurated by the chief guest tomorrow, ___ [Question Tags] (A) doesn't it (B) isn't it (C) wasn't it (D) hasn't it	1
Section D — Literature (Short Answer) Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
15	Do you think Ravi's mother will get to know about what had happened? <i>[Ch 7: Vitamin-M]</i>	2
16	How did the last remaining leaf on the creeper bring about a change in Johnsy's attitude towards life? <i>[Ch 5: Winds of Change]</i>	2
17	A canvas is similar to a garden plot as ____. <i>[Ch 6: Canvas of Soil]</i>	2
18	Sentila observes her mother making pots. What does this tell us about her? <i>[Ch 3: The Pot Maker]</i>	2
19	Speaker — Who appears to be the speaker and what is her/his role here? <i>[Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]</i>	2
20	How do they spend their time? How do you spend time with them? <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	2
21	What is the impact of the refrain, 'she's peerless, let's praise her!'? <i>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</i>	2
22	The phrase 'standing ovation' is an example of an adjective-noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 10: Nine Gold Medals]</i>	
23	Choose whether the given statements display: fact-opinion or cause-effect. (i) In the 2016 Rio Paralympic Games, I secured the silver medal in the shot-put event. (ii) I feel it was a moment of personal victory and a step forward in changing perceptions. <i>[Ch 9: The World of Limitless Possibilities]</i>	2
24	How could the poet feel his mother's presence, even though she isn't there? <i>[Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]</i>	2
Section E — Literature (Long Answer) Attempt all 4 questions. Each carries 5 mark(s).		
25	How does Subramania Bharati employ symbolism and allusion in the poem "Bharat Our Land" to celebrate India's spiritual and philosophical legacy? Explain with specific examples. <i>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</i>	5
26	What lessons can we infer from the grandmother's action of touching the narrator's feet? <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	5
27	Describe the process of pot making followed by expert pot makers, as observed by Sentila. <i>[Ch 3: The Pot Maker]</i>	5
28	The line "The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity" carries a deep meaning about the relationship between one's work and one's self. Explain the significance of this line, discussing how different workers express their identity through their work. <i>[Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]</i>	5

